

FREE SAMPLE

Tarantula Care Package

The first 5 pages of the 49-page printable manual, free to keep.



In this sample: What's inside, How to Use This Package, Quick Profile & Cost Overview, The Species Covered, Size & Lifespan. The contents page shows every one of the 49 pages, so you can see exactly what the full package covers before you buy it.

Not in this sample: the 44 pages that follow, which are the full care guide, the health section, the quick reference cards, and the owner tools, checklists and logs.

The full package is \$8.99 at beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/tarantula/. One purchase, and every corrected edition is a free re-download from your library. The free tarantula care guide it was built from is at beastlyfacts.com/guides/tarantula/, and stays free.

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Every page is written to be used, not just read once.

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START HERE

How to use this package

Three ways to get value from it, depending on where you are right now.

UNITS USED THROUGHOUT

Every temperature and size is given twice. Temperatures appear in degrees Fahrenheit (°F) with degrees Celsius (°C) beside them. Sizes appear in inches (in) with centimeters (cm) beside them, and a tarantula is measured by its leg span, diagonally from the tip of a front leg to the tip of the opposite back leg. Humidity is a percentage (%) of the moisture the air could hold. Sling containers are sold by volume, in drams for vials and ounces for cups. Prices are in United States dollars.

If you haven't set up yet

Check the law first, on page 25: a tarantula is legal with no permit in most of the United States, but a few places bar it and one state clears only three species. Then read pages 4 to 11 before buying anything. The enclosure shape is the decision that kills tarantulas: a ground-dweller in a tall enclosure has somewhere to fall from. Use the Budget & Shopping List on page 34 to buy once.

If your tarantula is already home

Audit the setup against the Setup Checklist on page 32, paying most attention to fall height, substrate depth and the water dish. If your spider has stopped eating, read page 15 before you worry: for a tarantula, weeks without food are usually normal. A shrunken, wrinkled abdomen is the real emergency, and it is on page 27.

Print these first

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|--|---|
| ☐ Page 32: Setup Checklist & Targets | ☐ Page 39: Pet-Sitter Sheet |
| ☐ Page 33: Emergency & Quick Targets Card | ☐ Page 40: Owner Log |
| ☐ Page 36: Symptom Quick Reference | ☐ Pages 41 and 42: Molt Log, Equipment & Vet Log |
| ☐ Page 37: Daily, Weekly & Yearly Routine | ☐ Page 43: Enrichment Checklist & Log |

WHICH TARANTULAS THIS PACKAGE FITS

More than 900 species exist, and they do not share one set of numbers. This package is written for the beginner species: the ground-dwelling (terrestrial) Chilean rose hair, curly hair, Brazilian black, Chaco golden knee and Mexican red knee, and the tree-dwelling (arboreal) pink toe. Where a figure belongs to one species, the page names it. Deep burrowers and the faster, more defensive species from Africa and Asia are outside its scope.

NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR

An exotics vet who will see an invertebrate, where one exists. Many areas have none, which is why this book leans hard on prevention. Find out now whether anyone within reach will see a tarantula, and write the number on the emergency card. Nothing on the law page is legal advice either.

SECTION 01 · PROFILE

Quick profile

Everything at a glance before you read the detail.

Family	Theraphosidae, the tarantulas: more than 900 species, on every continent except Antarctica
Species in this package	Chilean rose hair, curly hair, Brazilian black, Chaco golden knee and Mexican red knee on the ground; the pink toe in the trees
Adult size	Up to about 6 in (15 cm) leg span for a female rose hair, about 6.5 in (17 cm) for a curly hair, about 5 in (13 cm) for a female pink toe. Across the whole family, 2 to 12 in (5 to 30 cm)
Lifespan	Set by sex and species. A female rose hair commonly 15 to 20 years or more; a male about 5, 10 at the outside
Diet type	Carnivore: live insects only, with no formulated diet (page 12)
Enclosure (terrestrial adult)	About 20×10×10 in (51×25×25 cm), roughly a 10-gallon tank, floor about 3× the leg span, under about 12 in (30 cm) tall
The one hard rule	Keep a ground-dweller low. Height is the risk, floor area is the benefit, and a fall can rupture the abdomen (page 6)
Housing	One per enclosure. Most species are solitary and cannibalistic, and no enclosure size fixes that
Handling	Look, don't touch. The risk runs in both directions (page 17)
Conservation	Varies by species. Some, the rose hair among them, are listed under CITES, the Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora. Buy captive-bred

Cost overview

Initial setup

\$25 to \$100 for a beginner species, plus \$105 to \$305 for the setup, with every item priced: \$130 to \$405 all in. Every line is on page 34.

Ongoing

\$75 to \$235 a year, about \$5 to \$20 a month, most of it feeder insects, with gut-load food and fresh substrate the rest. No insurer covers a tarantula, and routine vet visits are not part of the budget.

THE REAL NUMBER TO SIT WITH

Not the money, the years. A female rose hair is a 15 to 20 year commitment on a budget most pets spend in a month, so the time is the thing to think through before you buy.

Fun facts worth knowing

- They digest food outside the body. Enzymes injected through the fangs liquefy the prey, a muscular sucking stomach pumps the meal in, and the empty shell is left behind as a small pellet.
- Females keep molting for life. Males stop at maturity, which is a large part of why a female can outlive a male by a decade or more.
- Their blood, called hemolymph, is not held in vessels. It flows freely around the organs, which is why a ruptured abdomen turns fatal so fast.

The species covered, size & lifespan

"Tarantula" covers animals with different needs. Know which one is in the enclosure.

Ask the seller for the species in Latin, and write it on the emergency card. It decides the enclosure, the humidity, the lifespan, and in one state whether you need a permit. New World tarantulas come from the Americas and defend themselves by flicking irritating hairs; every species below is one. Old World tarantulas, from Africa and Asia, are faster, more defensive and carry a stronger bite, and this package does not cover them.

SPECIES	LIVES	ADULT LEG SPAN	LIFESPAN AND NOTES
Chilean rose hair <i>Grammostola rosea</i>	On the ground	Up to about 6 in (15 cm)	Females 15 to 20 years or more; males about 5, 10 at the outside. Dry-adapted, and known for long fasts. Usually \$60 to \$70.
Curly hair <i>Tliltocatl albopilosus</i>	On the ground	About 6.5 in (17 cm)	Females 25 years or longer; males around 5. Usually \$30 to \$40.
Brazilian black <i>Grammostola pulchra</i>	On the ground	Not listed	The species in the one controlled housing study (page 19).
Chaco golden knee <i>Grammostola pulchripes</i>	On the ground	Not listed	With the rose hair and the Brazilian black, one of the three tarantulas Maine leaves unrestricted.
Mexican red knee <i>Brachypelma</i>	On the ground	Not listed	Females 25 to 30 years; males rarely past 10. Its genus is on CITES Appendix II.
Pink toe <i>Avicularia avicularia</i>	In trees and bushes	About 5 in (13 cm) for a female, 3.5 in (9 cm) for a male	About 4 to 8 years on average. Needs a tall enclosure and more airflow (page 7). Usually \$30 to \$40.

No adult size is listed for these species.

Lifespan: the sex decides it

Females keep molting their whole adult lives. Males stop at the molt that makes them mature, and most die within about a year of reaching maturity and mating. That is why two spiders of one species can differ by a decade or more. A male rose hair lives about 5 years in all; a female 15 to 20 or more. Slings are usually sold unsexed, so an unsexed spiderling is a coin flip on lifespan. How sexing works is on page 24.

CITES AND BUYING CAPTIVE-BRED

CITES is the treaty that controls trade in listed animals between countries. The genera *Brachypelma*, *Tliltocatl* and *Poecilotheria* are on its Appendix II, and the Chilean rose hair joined them in March 2026. Buying captive-bred adds nothing to the capture of wild animals, and a captive-bred spider is less likely to carry parasites (page 20).